

PORTFOLIO STRATEGY REVIEW

Indie SaaS Portfolio: The Market, The Performance, and The Path Forward

Where this portfolio is concentrated, where it isn't, and where that points for what comes next



Market



Performance



Risk



Opportunities

The portfolio is large, healthy in aggregate, and dangerously concentrated

Implied \$161.7M ARR across 1,000 startups, but the top 20 (2%) generate 57.7% of it. Every finding in this deck traces back to that tension.

\$161.7M



Implied portfolio ARR (MRR x 12)

\$282



Median monthly MRR per startup

19.7%



Startups earning \$0 MRR

57.7%



Share of MRR from top 20 startups

262



Startups currently listed for sale

46



Countries represented in the portfolio

Fewer failures, but also fewer moonshots, than the broader indie SaaS market

Against a 2025 market-wide study of Stripe-verified indie SaaS products, this portfolio's outcomes are compressed toward the middle — safer, but with a thinner breakout tail.

Metric	This portfolio	Broader indie SaaS market
Startups earning \$0 MRR	19.7%	~54%
Median MRR among revenue-earners	\$1,036	~\$4,200
Startups exceeding \$100K MRR	1.6%	~5%

Read it both ways

Fewer zeros suggests this is an already-curated set, not a random slice of side projects. But the lower breakout rate and lower earner median suggest the winners here are, on average, smaller than the market's best.

Source: 2025 analysis of Stripe-verified Indie Hackers products (ScrapingFish, via BuildMVPFast).

● MARKET LANDSCAPE — THE PATTERN

This portfolio is concentrated on every axis we measured — except one

A small share of companies, one country, and unnamed founders each capture a disproportionate share of revenue. Category is the exception: the largest category earns almost exactly its proportional share.

BY COMPANY

Top 5 startups

share of startups

0.5%

share of revenue

40.3%

~80x their size

BY GEOGRAPHY

US-based startups

share of startups

34%

share of revenue

63.1%

~1.9x their size

BY OWNERSHIP

Anonymous listings

share of startups

13%

share of revenue

26.9%

~2.1x their size

BY CATEGORY (THE EXCEPTION)

AI, the largest category

share of startups

27%

share of revenue

31%

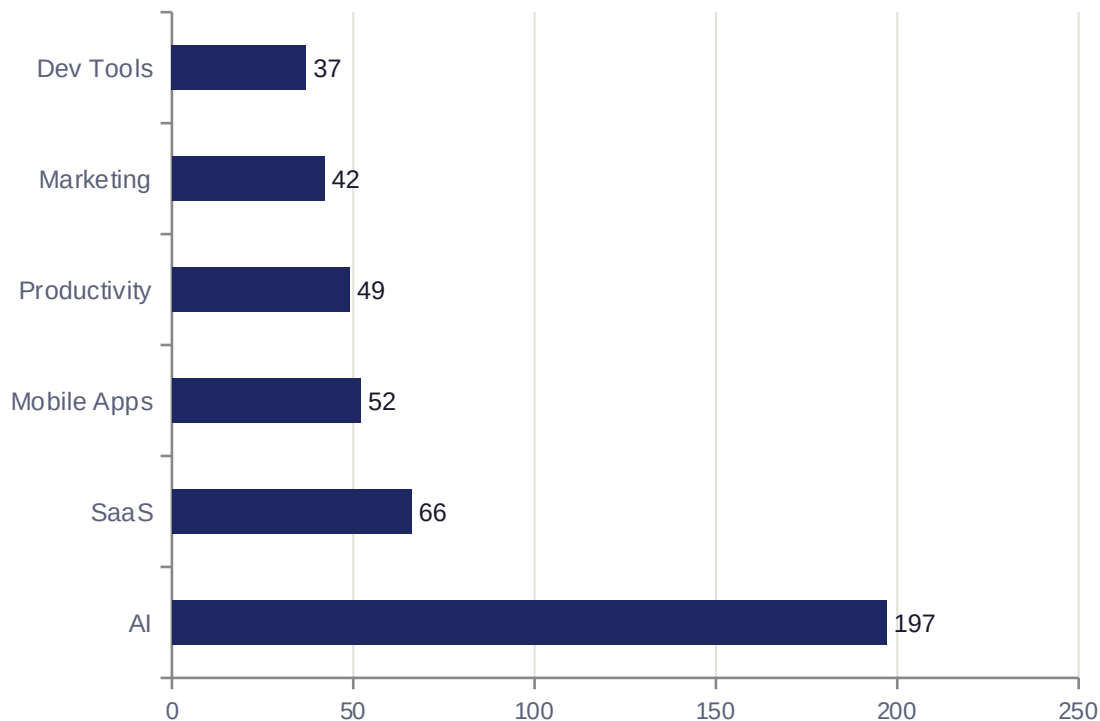
~1.1x — proportional

● MARKET LANDSCAPE — THE EXCEPTION

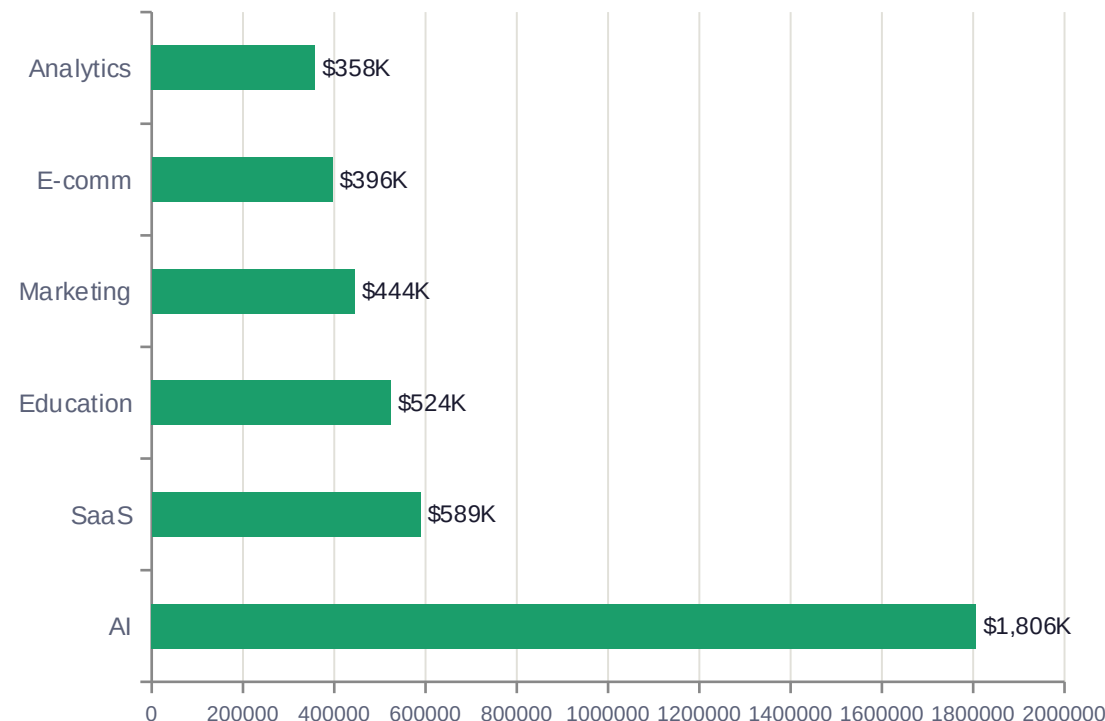
Category is the one axis that isn't concentrated — but it's still not efficient

AI's revenue share roughly matches its headcount share — no concentration there. But per company, Education generates 7x AI's revenue efficiency, without needing outsized headcount.

By startup count (top 6)

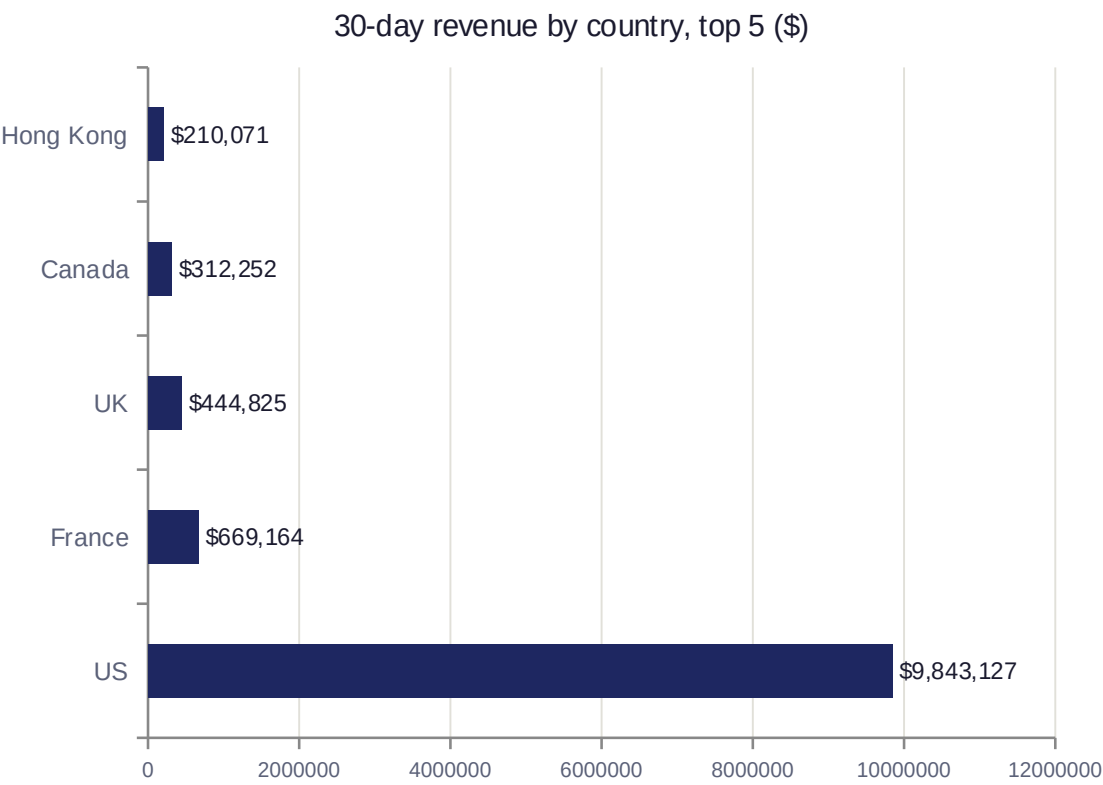


By total MRR (top 6)



Behind the US's 63% revenue share: a long tail with uneven monetization

Beyond the headline concentration number, two contrasts stand out: a web-first platform mix, and a pricing-power gap in one of the portfolio's larger non-US markets.



Payment provider	Startups	Median MRR
Superwall (mobile paywalls)	17	\$5,465
Stripe (core web SaaS)	636	\$663
RevenueCat (mobile IAP)	189	\$237
Paddle (merchant-of-record)	16	\$146

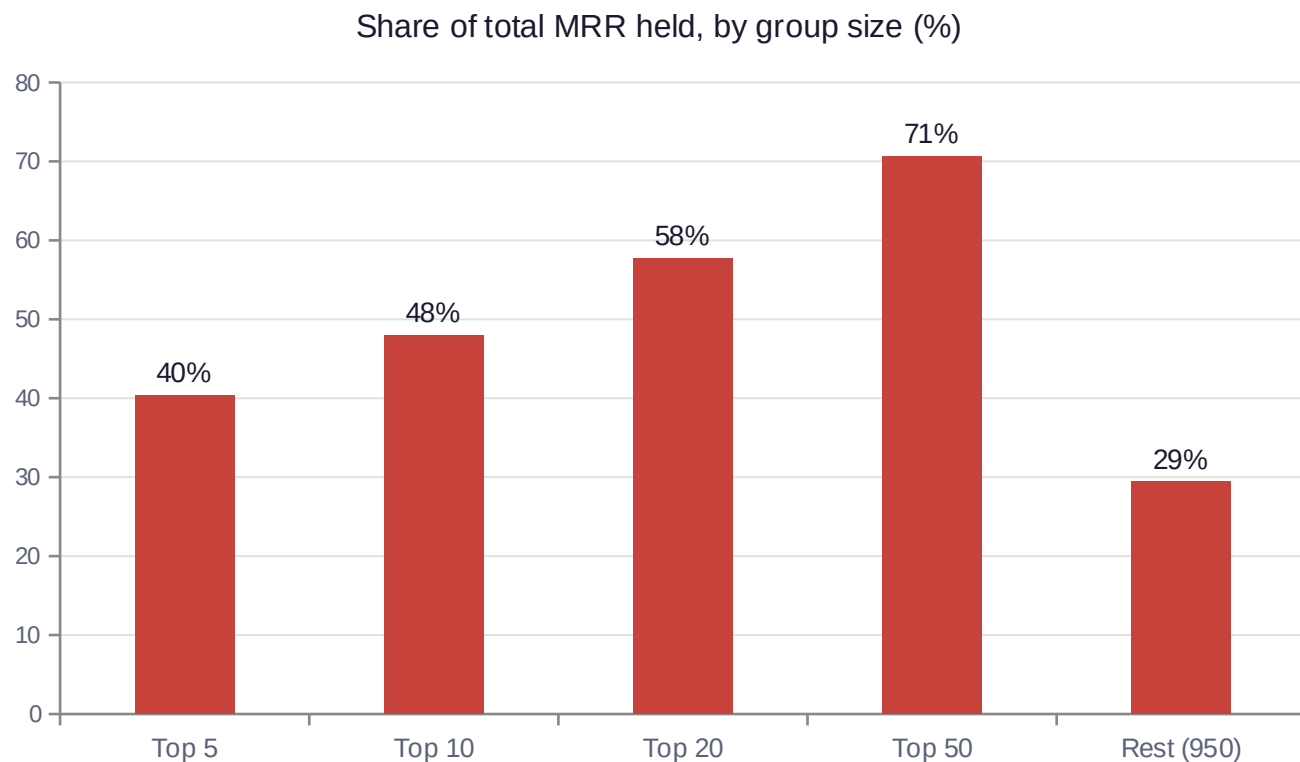
Note: Superwall's median rests on only 17 startups — directionally interesting, not yet a reliable basis for a sourcing decision on its own.

India (59 startups) ranks 3rd by count but trails 6 smaller markets in revenue — a pricing-power gap, not a demand gap.

● MARKET LANDSCAPE — THE SHARPEST CUT

Of all four axes, company-level concentration is the most extreme — and the most costly

80x its size, from the previous slide: 5 startups hold 40% of MRR. If they alone churned, the portfolio loses \$65.2M in implied ARR overnight.



Read: the 5 largest startups alone hold 40% of monthly revenue; the 950 smallest combined hold only 29%.

Cost if it goes wrong

Stan alone churns

-26.5% · -\$42.8M ARR

Top 5 churn

-40.3% · -\$65.2M ARR

Top 10 churn

-48.0% · -\$77.6M ARR

One company, Stan, is larger than the next three combined

3 of the top 8 positions are unnamed 'Stealth Company' entries — an ownership visibility gap the board should close before relying on this list.

Startup	Category	MRR	30d growth
Stan	Unclassified	\$3,569,654	-7.6%
Stealth Company	Unclassified	\$747,069	+138.4%
GojiberryAI	AI	\$494,668	+19.7%
Stealth Company	Unclassified	\$364,101	+3.7%
Rezi	AI	\$259,701	-0.2%
Kibu	Education	\$234,319	-25.6%
Cometly	Analytics	\$207,616	+17.0%
1Lookup	SaaS	\$207,064	-5.8%

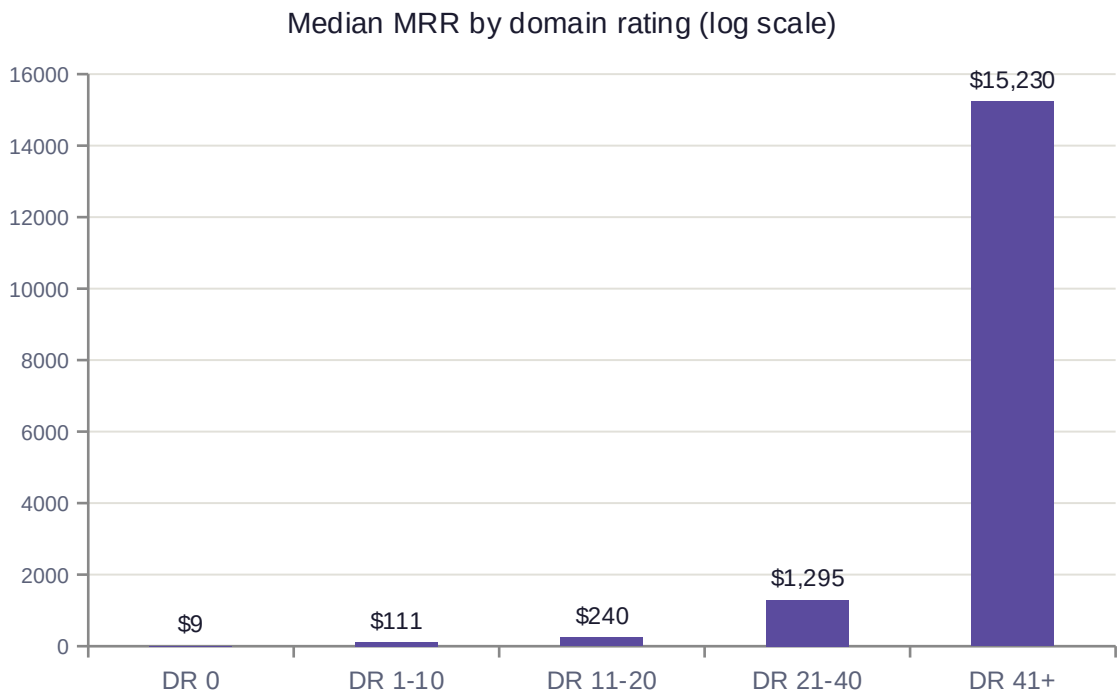
The fastest-growing names are early-stage, not yet portfolio-material

Triple-digit growth is concentrated under \$30K MRR — real momentum, but growth % on a small base can look extreme without moving the portfolio.

Startup	Category	MRR	30d growth
HotelHero.ai	AI	\$1,460	+1,245.3%
Stealth Company	Unclassified	\$135,899	+718.9%
Hong Xuan Kow	AI	\$20,254	+598.2%
Backlinker AI	Marketing	\$26,950	+577.3%
BillionVerify	Marketing	\$1,292	+547.6%
Spool	Mobile Apps	\$704	+524.6%
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	\$1,076	+427.3%
Clarity Search AI	AI	\$3,645	+367.9%

Two independent signals predict revenue — each with a blind spot

The ownership concentration flagged earlier (anonymous listings ~2.1x their size) shows up here in more detail — alongside a second, independent predictor: domain authority.



Metric (8,782-startup universe)	Named	Anon.
Share of listings	93.7%	6.3%
Share of total MRR	72.8%	27.2%
Median MRR	\$0	\$73

Blind spot: anonymity isn't a red flag here — it correlates with being further along. But it also means the board can't currently attribute ~27% of tracked revenue to a real owner.

Blind spot: 286 of 1,000 startups have no scoreable domain (app-only/stealth) — and that group out-earns the rated group.

Audience size is not converting to revenue for a meaningful subset

Several startups carry six-figure follower counts with effectively zero monetization — a distribution problem, not a demand problem.

Startup	Category	X followers	MRR
Stealth Company	SaaS	365,992	\$0
Stalkr	AI	361,974	\$0
Tillpoint	E-comm	229,439	\$44
Looker.so	Unclassified	60,428	\$0
The Visual Hackademy	Unclassified	52,055	\$0
ConfettiTherapy.com	Entertainment	29,306	\$0
Groove Hiring	Recruiting & HR	23,444	\$29
Lumail	Marketing	21,957	\$20

51 startups above \$1K MRR are shrinking by more than 30% a month

Three names collapsed to -100% growth this period — over \$68K in MRR gone in 30 days. This table shows the 8 most severe of 51 total.

Startup	Category	MRR	30d growth
Produce.so	Content Creation	\$27,371	-100.0%
DropPop	SaaS	\$27,797	-100.0%
Stealth Company	Unclassified	\$13,066	-100.0%
Barron Tech LLC	Sales	\$2,700	-80.6%
securenow.ai	Security	\$1,613	-79.0%
AI MONEY GROUP	AI	\$10,680	-65.8%
Grafics	AI	\$1,022	-64.4%
VoiceCheap	AI	\$3,172	-62.6%

A -100% reading often means a broken revenue-tracking integration, not necessarily true churn — recommend operational verification before acting.

262 startups are for sale — the best deals combine high growth with a low multiple

Total asking price across all 262 listings: \$86.8M. These 6 are priced under 3x revenue while growing over 50% month-on-month.

Startup	Category	MRR	30d growth	Asking price	Multiple
Backlinker AI	Marketing	\$26,950	+577.3%	\$350,000	1.3x
Speel.co	SaaS	\$65,843	+252.5%	\$500,000	0.0x
JuggleHire	Recruiting & HR	\$1,817	+178.9%	\$12,000	0.7x
Kickly - Pronos IA	Games	\$10,236	+178.7%	\$100,000	0.7x
Bloom	Content Creation	\$15,522	+160.0%	\$200,000	0.7x
InstaTrack	Mobile Apps	\$3,204	+131.4%	\$30,000	0.5x

Caution: sub-1x multiples with high growth need scrutiny. One listing (Rolely) shows 326.8x on just \$16.67 MRR — a brand/domain-value play, not a comparable revenue multiple.

● OPPORTUNITIES — STRATEGIC WHITESPACE

Category was the one axis not already concentrated — that's exactly where to source next

You can't structurally out-diversify company, geography, or ownership concentration — they're inherent to how this market works. Category is the one axis still open.

1

Tilt sourcing toward B2B

B2B earns 5.7x the median MRR of B2C (\$1,036 vs \$181) on far fewer entrants (255 vs 401) — better economics, less noise to filter.

2

Prioritize Education and Marketing

Both post top-4 total category revenue with a fraction of AI's headcount — a less saturated, higher-willingness-to-pay buyer base.

3

Underwrite the sub-1x acquisition list

Several listed startups combine 100%+ growth with sub-1x multiples — even conservative diligence should clear a subset as accretive buys.